ZEESHAN IMDAD

Senior Software Engineer — Observability & Distributed Systems | Java 17/21, Spring Boot, Go | OpenTelemetry, Kafka
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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer and technical lead with 7+ years building resilient, secure distributed systems in Java 17/21, Spring Boot and Go, including two years on SolarWinds' Observability Platform. Builds vendor-neutral OpenTelemetry instrumentation and telemetry pipelines (traces, metrics, logs over OTLP to New Relic and Datadog), Kafka-based ingestion and SLO-driven, actionable alerting across Kubernetes on Azure, AWS, GCP and on-premises environments. Leads a team of 6 at ADCB on payment, anti-fraud and incident-response platforms, mentoring engineers and setting standards for code quality, testing and CI/CD.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Java 17/21 (JVM GC tuning, virtual threads), Spring Boot 3.x, Spring Security, Project Reactor, Kotlin, Go, Python (FastAPI, Django), TypeScript, React
Observability: OpenTelemetry (Java & Go SDKs, Java agent auto-instrumentation, Collector, OTLP, semantic conventions, context propagation), Distributed Tracing, Micrometer, New Relic (NRQL), Datadog, AppDynamics, Prometheus, Grafana, Elasticsearch/Kibana, pprof
Reliability: SLOs & Error Budgets, MTTD/MTTR, Actionable Alerting (PagerDuty, ServiceNow), Telemetry Sampling, Cardinality & Retention, Runbooks, On-Call, Resilience4j, Circuit Breakers, Back-pressure, Idempotency
Data & Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, SQS/SNS, Spark Structured Streaming, Flink, ClickHouse, BigQuery, PostgreSQL, Oracle, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis
Cloud & Platform: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Azure (AKS), AWS (EKS, ECR, CloudWatch), GCP (GKE), On-Prem OpenStack, Bare-Metal & Air-Gapped Environments, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, ArgoCD)
Security & Engineering: OAuth2, JWT, mTLS, HMAC Request Signing, Fraud/Risk Decisioning; System Design, HLD/LLD Specifications, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, DDD, SOLID; TDD (JUnit 5, Testcontainers, Pact, go test), PR Reviews, Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Backend Engineer — ADCB (Abu Dhabi Commercial Bank), Abu Dhabi — Nov 2025 – Present

- Lead a team of 6 engineers in regulated banking: HLD/LLD technical specifications, estimation, task breakdown, design and PR reviews.
- **Enterprise Payment Orchestration** (architecture): built greenfield card, wallet and anti-fraud services in Java 17/21, Kotlin and Spring Boot 3.x on AKS for 100K+ transactions, with idempotent Kafka/SQS consumers, Resilience4j back-pressure, SLOs and error budgets, and reconciliation against core banking; instrumented with the OpenTelemetry Java agent and SDK plus Micrometer, trace context propagation, and New Relic (NRQL dashboards, alerting) and AppDynamics.
- Released fraud/risk logic changes on evidence: routed a controlled slice of production traffic to hardened services, comparing latency, error and false-positive/negative rates before rollout; secured service traffic with OAuth2 and mTLS.
- Fixed production incidents at root cause: GC-pressure latency spikes (collector and thread-pool tuning, singleton bean scope), wallet deadlocks (consistent lock ordering, shorter transactions) and duplicate payments from Kafka redeliveries (idempotent state transitions).
- **Telemetry Analytics & Kafka Automation** (architecture): cut incident troubleshooting time by ~40% with Python/FastAPI analytics over 100K+ daily events on Kafka, auto-remediating known patterns; ran OTel Collector pipelines across AKS and on-prem bare-metal and air-gapped environments, correlating metrics, logs and traces to improve MTTD and MTTR.
- **AI Operations Copilot** (architecture): built a LangGraph multi-agent assistant (Azure OpenAI, Pinecone RAG, 2M+ docs) that grounds alerts, runbooks and tickets across 10 banking services for on-call, with a validation gate and human sign-off; contributed to ~60% lower MTTR.

Senior Software Engineer, Observability Platform — SolarWinds — Jul 2023 – Nov 2025

- **High-Throughput Observability Platform** (architecture): built Go stream processors and Java/Spring Boot ETL workers ingesting Kafka telemetry into ClickHouse, PostgreSQL and MongoDB, with Project Reactor back-pressure, ingest-time data shaping and query tuning delivering sub-second p99 query latency.
- Built the vendor-neutral OpenTelemetry layer: Collector pipelines receiving OTLP traces, metrics and logs from Go and Java services (SDKs and Java agent auto-instrumentation), semantic conventions and context propagation for distributed tracing, OTLP export to New Relic and Datadog, and sampling, cardinality and retention policies to control telemetry cost.
- Enabled 1-second anomaly alerting into ServiceNow and PagerDuty with Spark Structured Streaming on GCP (GKE, BigQuery), isolated from the query path; made LLM alert summaries non-blocking with provider failover, circuit breakers and token budgets.
- Shipped to AWS (EKS) via CI/CD and Terraform; secured partner APIs with OAuth2, mTLS and HMAC signing; profiled live Java and Go services (pprof) to fix race conditions and lock contention, and coached 4 engineers on performance profiling and production debugging.

Backend Engineer, Platform Integrations — Publicis Sapient (Fintech) — Jul 2021 – Jul 2023

- **Legacy Banking Integration Platform** (architecture): refactored banking integrations into SOLID/DDD Spring Boot, Django and Go services over REST/MQ with Redis caching, sliding-window rate limiting, idempotent calls ending duplicate payments, and canary/blue-green releases (ArgoCD).

Software Engineer, Distributed Telemetry Pipeline — Wipro Limited — Aug 2019 – Jul 2021

- **Distributed Telemetry Ingestion Pipeline** (architecture): sustained 4x traffic growth at 99.95% availability with Go, Kafka, Redis and Kubernetes, using idempotent checkpointed processors, dead-letter queues and consumer-lag autoscaling.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering — Galgotias University, 2019
Certifications: Oracle Certified Professional, Java (2023) · OCI 2025 Multicloud Architect Professional · OCI 2025 Developer Professional · Confluent Kafka Fundamentals (2021) · Distributed Systems & Cloud Computing Specialization, Coursera (2020)
Algorithms & CS Fundamentals: 1000+ LeetCode/GFG problems · 2nd place regionally, ICPAC · 3rd place, HOWATHON 2022